

Applied Performance Task, Expectations and Rubric

The Task

Students begin by examining the amount of protected land in Canada. In group of three, they are to create a PowerPoint or Corel presentation of one of the national park of their choice. In order to do their presentation, they have to research the specific national park and ecozone and they have to present collected information on the parks' location and history, on the natural and human characteristics, and on other distinguishing features. Each student in the group has to choose one of the administrative roles listed below, create and present 5 slides for a minimum of 15 slides and a maximum of 25. Student are instructed to include supporting visuals, such as maps, graphs, charts, diagrams, pictures, and animation in their presentation.

Administrative Roles

1. Park warden

- Human use
- Location of major cities close by
- Park History
- Major attractions/recreation/facilities in the Park

2. Ecologist

- Ecozone information of your Park
- Wildlife and Endangered species present in the Park
- Vegetation in the Park

3. Earth Scientist

- Major Landforms of the Park
- Climate in the Park
- Soils of the Park
- Drainage system in the Park

❖ For the presentation we recommend to book a computer room with an infocus projector.

Expectations

This task gives students the opportunity to demonstrate achievement of the following selected expectations from four strands: Geographic Foundations: Space and Systems; Human-Environment Interactions, Understanding and Managing Change; and Methods of Geographic Inquiry.

Students will:

1. identify and evaluate patterns of spatial organization, including land use, population distribution, and ecozones;
2. demonstrate a knowledge of the characteristics of natural systems (e.g., climate, landforms, water, soils, natural vegetation, wildlife);
3. demonstrate a knowledge of the characteristics of human systems (e.g. transportation, population, communication, energy networks, industry);
4. demonstrate an understanding of the ways in which natural and human system function as part of a whole;

5. describe selected Canadian ecozones;
6. demonstrate an understanding of how human activities (e.g., rural and urban development, waste management, parks development, forest harvesting, land reclamation) affect the environment;
7. demonstrate an understanding of how natural systems (e.g., climate, soils, landforms, wildlife) influence cultural and economic activities (e.g., recreation, transportation, employment opportunities);
8. communicate the results of geographic inquiries using appropriate methods and technologies, and present viewpoints on issues affecting Canadians.
9. use geographic material from primary sources (e.g., field research, surveys, interviews) and secondary sources (e.g., mainstream and alternative media, CD-ROMs, Internet) effectively and appropriately when researching a geographic issue;
10. select and use appropriate methods for displaying geographic data;

Prior Knowledge and Skills

To complete this task, students are expected to be able to demonstrate the following:

- knowledge of the definition of an ecozone
- knowledge of some of Canada's ecozones and their physical characteristics (e.g. landforms, climate, vegetation, and soils)
- understanding of the physical processes that have shaped Canada's ecozones (e.g. rock cycle; tectonic forces such as volcanism, folding, and faulting; glaciations)
- knowledge of purpose and types of national parks (e.g. for recreation, conservation, or preservation) and the characteristics of each type
- understanding of research methods using a variety of source materials
- ability to read, analyse, and interpret graphs and maps
- ability to use a variety of tools and technologies for research

Task Rubric – Computer Presentation (PowerPoint or Corel) of a chosen Park or Conservation Area

Expectations	Criteria	Level 1 (50–59)	Level 2 (60–69)	Level 3 (70–79)	Level 4 (80–100)
Knowledge / understanding					
1, 2, 3, 5	• Demonstrates knowledge of the selected ecozone of their chosen park • Demonstrate a knowledge of the characteristics of natural and human systems	• Demonstrates limited knowledge of the selected ecozone • Demonstrates limited knowledge of the characteristics of natural and human systems	• Demonstrates some knowledge of the selected ecozone • Demonstrates some knowledge of the characteristics of natural and human systems	• Demonstrates considerable knowledge of the selected ecozone • Demonstrates considerable knowledge of the characteristics of natural and human systems	• Demonstrates thorough knowledge of the selected ecozone • Demonstrates thorough knowledge of the characteristics of natural and human systems
Thinking / Inquiry					
6, 7	• Uses a variety of relevant supporting facts, details and information about their parks' ecozone • Explains the significance of the information selected	• Uses a limited variety of relevant supporting facts, details and information about their parks' ecozone • Explains the significance to a limited degree	• Uses some variety of relevant supporting facts, details and information about their parks' ecozone • Explains the significance to some degree	• Uses a considerable variety of relevant supporting facts, details and information about their parks' ecozone • Explains the significance to a considerable degree	• Uses a wide variety of relevant supporting facts, details and information about their parks' ecozone • Explains the significance to a high degree
Communication					
8, 9, 10	• Uses visuals to illustrate the importance of the human and natural systems • Communicate using appropriate methods and technologies through logical organization for different audiences	• Uses visuals to illustrate the importance to a limited degree • Minimal logic in plan and sequence where organization interferes with comprehension • Oral skills shows limited effectiveness to deliver presentation	• Uses visuals to illustrate the importance to some degree • Some logic in plan and sequence where lapses of organization interfere with comprehension • Oral skills shows effectiveness to deliver presentation	• Uses visuals to illustrate the importance to a considerable degree • Logic in plan and sequence where organization is effective and do not interfere with comprehension • Oral skills shows effectiveness and confidence to deliver presentation	• Uses visuals to illustrate the importance to a high degree • Thoughtful and logic in plan and sequence where organization enhance comprehension • Oral skills creatively and effectively deliver presentation
Application					
4	• Explain how natural and human systems function as part of a whole in their chosen park	• Shows limited explanations	• Shows some explanations	• Shows considerable explanations	• Shows thorough explanations